

Ancient History





About the Course

Study history stories about the ancient civilizations that lived from 100 BC to 350 AD. View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	The Bronze Bow Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6
History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 5-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6



The Bronze Bow



Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Ancient History: Grades 5-6 Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 5 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 5 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 6 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 6 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History\)](#)
- ∞ [History: Grades 5-6 \(U.S.\) Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)
- ∞ [History: Grades 5-6 \(Canada\) Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Ancient History: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1

Materials: Bronze Bow, The Student Bible Atlas

→ INTRO

The Bronze Bow, winner of the 1962 Newbery Medal, is set in Galilee during the time of Jesus's ministry (approximately 28–33 AD). Galilee had been occupied by Rome for almost 100 years when the story takes place, and the people longed for freedom from Roman oppression. As we read the story, we'll explore both the Galilee region and the culture of Rome during this time period.

∞ Video Link: The Culture at the Time of Jesus' Birth

∞ Video Link: Galilee at the Time of Jesus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1

- Why do you think Daniel trusts Joel and Malthace so quickly?
- What would you miss most if you had to leave your home?

→ MAPWORK

Map Resource: The Student Bible Atlas

- Find the area of Galilee on p.23 or use the Map of Galilee link provided. Notice that Galilee was an area near the Sea of Galilee, not the name of a city. (The name Galilee-Hebrew word galil, which translates to "district," "circle," or "region".)
 - Now locate the Sea of Galilee and the town of Capernaum. The twins were moving to this town.
 - Much of the story takes place in the village of Ketzah, but this is a fictitious town. In the book, it is said to be on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee, three miles from Capernaum. Can you estimate where this would have been located on your map?
- ∞ Map Link: Map of Galilee

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Roman Catapult

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Daniel and his conversation with the twin brother and sister (Joel and Malthace)?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2

- How does Samson's condition show the harshness of the ancient world?
- What early signs do we see about Rosh's character and leadership?

→ BACKGROUND

This chapter includes a man who is a slave. Under Roman law, enslaved people had no rights and were regarded as the property of their masters. They could be bought, sold, and mistreated at will. They were unable to own property, enter into a contract, or legally marry.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.19 where a man is killed with a dagger.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Meet a Roman Legionary

Note: Though this video shows a Roman Legionary in England rather than Israel, the uniforms and lifestyle would have been very similar.

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What happened with Sampson the slave in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

Look closely for details on how the Jewish Sabbath is observed during this

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Website Link: Gleaning by Hand

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

chapter. The Sabbath would have been observed from Friday night to Saturday night. Sabbath comes from the Hebrew word *Shabbat*, which literally translates to "to rest" or "to cease".

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3

- Why do you think Simon says that he and Rosh "work for the same end, but we don't exactly see eye to eye."
- Why is Daniel reluctant to visit his grandmother and sister? How does he feel once he is there?

→ BACKGROUND

Daniel had run away from Amalek, a cruel blacksmith, where he was a bonded servant. A bonded servant worked for a master, usually to learn a trade or to pay off debt, for a set number of years. Although biblical law mandated protections for indentured Hebrew servants, Amalek treated Daniel cruelly. Unable to endure the abuse, Daniel broke his bond and fled into the mountains, making him a runaway and a fugitive from justice.

Daniel's grandmother mentions a "pauper's share" of grain in this chapter. This ancient practice was called gleaning. Landowners were to leave the edges of their fields unharvested so that the poor and widows could gather the grain to feed themselves. This wasn't easy - it took a lot of work to gather the grain, separate it, grind it, and turn it into coarse flour to make bread! Do you remember any Bible stories that mention gleaning?

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4

Materials: Bronze Bow, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Simon's visit to Daniel and Daniel's visit to his grandmother in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4

- Why does Jesus' message seem strange to Daniel?
- Why do you think Daniel left his grandmother's house to go back to the cave?

→ MAPWORK

Map Resource: The Student Bible Atlas

- Find Nazareth on p.23 or use the Map of Galilee link provided.
- Find Chorazin where the grandmother sells his sister's weaving on the map.
- ∞ Map Link: Map of Galilee

• EXTRA HELPING

- ∞ Video Link: 1st Century Nazareth Village Comes to Life
- ∞ Video Link: 1st Century Synagogue

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5

Materials: Bronze Bow, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 (The next lesson has fewer pages if you need to save part of this chapter for next time.)

- Why did the people in Capernaum act differently toward the Roman soldiers than Daniel did? Was one right or wrong?
- How does Hezron's approach to the Roman occupation differ from the

• EXTRA HELPING

- ∞ Video Link: Exploring the Ancient City of Tiberius
- ∞ Video Link: Capernaum Tour

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Zealots'? Which do you think is wiser?

→ BACKGROUND

In this chapter, Daniel travels to the city of Capernaum. Nestled on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee, Capernaum was a prosperous fishing village and busy hub of daily life in first-century Galilee. Its rich waters and location along major trade routes made it a natural gathering place. It was also the home base of Jesus during his years of ministry.

Also mentioned in this chapter, Tiberias was built around 20 AD by Herod Antipas and named for the reigning Roman Emperor. Situated along the western shore of the Sea of Galilee near 17 natural hot springs, it served as the Roman capital of Galilee and was meant to show off Roman life. Its construction over an ancient cemetery made it ritually unclean under Jewish law. This initially kept observant Jews away, though it later became a major center of Jewish scholarship.

→ MAPWORK

□ Map Resource: The Student Bible Atlas

- On p.12 of your Bible Atlas, locate the town of Capernaum.
- On p.12 of your Bible Atlas, locate the town of Tiberias.

WEEK 6 □ 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6

□ Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Capernaum or Joel's family home there?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6

- Why do Joel and Thacia help Daniel even though hiding him could bring trouble to their household?
- Daniel feels insulted by the Roman soldier's command. Was his reaction understandable, wise, both, or neither? Why?

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries.

WEEK 7 □ 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7

□ Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7

- What did you learn about Daniel's family and why he hates the Romans?
- Does Daniel want justice or revenge? How are they different?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the sister's story on p.83 as parts may be frightening. Skip sentences or summarize as needed.

WEEK 8 □ 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8

□ Materials: Bronze Bow, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you learn about Daniel in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

Many people in first-century Judea expected a Messiah who would overthrow Rome, but Jesus' work pointed to a different kind of kingdom.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- Why do you think Simon's decision surprises Daniel?
- How do Jesus' healing and teaching differ from Rosh's plans for freedom?

→ MAPWORK

📄 Map Resource: The Student Bible Atlas

- Locate Bethsaida on p.23
- Locate Cana on p.23.

The distance walking would be roughly 30 miles. The family with the injured boy walked from Cana to Bethsaida.

WEEK 9 📅 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9

📄 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10

- How does Rosh treat Daniel? How does this compare to the villagers' treatment of Daniel?
- How does Daniel's return home begin to change him?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.106-107 for description of a stabbing and p.113-115 for descriptions of the girl having devils and/or being possessed by the devils.

WEEK 10 📅 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10

📄 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What happened in the village in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11

- How does Daniel's life begin to change in this chapter? How does Leah begin to change?
- What does Daniel learn about sacrifice in this chapter?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview content on p.125 with continued story of the sister possibly demon possessed.

WEEK 11 📅 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11

📄 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12

- Why do you think the group of boys is growing so quickly?
- Why do you think the Roman soldier was around so often and then quit coming by? Do you think it was due to the meetings or something else?

→ BACKGROUND

If you wanted to make money in the Roman World as a Jew, you might want to become a tax collector. But, as a tax collector, you'd make many enemies as well and likely be viewed as a traitor. Many tax collectors became a source of great anger throughout Rome. There were many cases where tax collectors outright stole from or imprisoned their own people. There are two famous tax collectors in the Bible. One is Matthew,

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Term 1

who was a disciple of Jesus as well as the writer of the Gospel of Matthew. The other was a man named Zacchaeus, whose story is recorded in Luke 19.

WEEK 12 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Bronze Bow

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what you remember about the story so far.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13

- Why do you think Thacia was able to reach Leah?
- How does Daniel's life now compare to his life with Rosh?

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14

- Why does Daniel return to Rosh? Why does he leave again?
- How does Daniel's time in the village change the way he sees life on the mountain?

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Daniel's return to the mountain?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15

- How does Daniel feel about his morning visits to the city versus the evening?
- Has the crowd or conditions changed since the first time Daniel heard Jesus speak?

→ BACKGROUND

This chapter mentions the month of Ab, which would be in July and August.

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Herod Antipas was a powerful ruler who governed the regions of Galilee and Perea during the first century AD. His family was considered only half Jewish, as his ancestors were not born Jewish but had Judaism forced on them generations earlier. This made many full-blooded Jewish people resent his family's rule. He was the son of the infamous Herod the Great and governed under Roman authority. In the New Testament, he is sometimes called "King Herod." He is best known for ordering the execution of John the Baptist and for his role in the trial of Jesus. History remembers him as a cruel leader who used his power to silence anyone

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

who challenged him.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16

- Why do you think Joel is willing to risk so much?
- Why do you think Thacia says there is beauty in being alive in Galilee when it is occupied by Romans?

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Joel from the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17

- What is the difference between a leader who serves people and one who uses people?
- Why is Daniel becoming uneasy with the local boys and with Rosh?

→ BACKGROUND

The Roman catapult was a form of heavy artillery. These large devices could hurl heavy stones, flaming projectiles, or other objects at enemy walls and fortifications from a distance. Roman engineers were skilled at building and using them, and catapults gave Roman armies

∞ Video Link: The Roman Catapult

The ancient city of Sepphoris sat in a prime location in the region of Galilee, which meant it was a city worth fighting over. Because of where it was positioned, Sepphoris was attacked and besieged multiple times throughout its long history.

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.18-19

- How do Daniel and Rosh compare as leaders?
- In what ways was their mission to rescue Joel a success? A failure?
- What was your reaction to Sampson's sacrifice?

→ BACKGROUND

The month of Ebul is in August / September. Being sent to the galleys (rowing the ships) would have been the next most serious punishment after execution. Most Roman prisoners were either killed or forced into hard labor.

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you remember about Joel's rescue?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Ch.20

- Why do you think Joel still wants to follow Rosh after being captured?
- Why do Daniel and Joel believe Jesus may be the leader they are looking for rather than Rosh?

→ BACKGROUND

This chapter takes place in the month of Tishri, which is in September / October. The Day of Atonement is also included in this chapter. Yom Kippur, known as the Day of Atonement, holds the highest place on the Jewish calendar. Observed on the 10th of Tishri, the day is marked by fasting, reflection, and coming before God to ask for forgiveness. Though the tone is serious and solemn, there is hope as well. This is a time the slate can be wiped clean of sin for a fresh start.

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21

- Why is Jesus not the kind of leader Daniel expected?
- Why is it so difficult for Daniel to let go of hatred?

WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did Daniel learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22

- Is Daniel justified in his anger? In his treatment of Leah?
- What does this chapter show about the cost of refusing to forgive?

WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23

- How does Simon's understanding of Jesus differ from Daniel's?
- Why does Daniel feel so disappointed after talking with Simon?

WEEK 11 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

How do you think the story will end?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 2

- How has Daniel changed by the end of the story?
- Why is Daniel's invitation to Marcus such a powerful ending?
- How does the meaning of the bronze bow change at the end of the novel?

→ BACKGROUND

When Jesus began his ministry in Judea, everything he taught went against the way Rome operated. Rome was built on military power, conquest, and crushing its enemies, but Jesus taught something radically different. Roman leaders saw Christians as troublemakers and had many of them arrested or killed. But the faith Jesus started kept spreading anyway, moving from person to person and town to town across the empire. After about 300 years, something remarkable happens. You will read about that in the next book when you learn about the Roman Emperor Constantine.

WEEK 12 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Bronze Bow

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25

The Ancient Church; Peter

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

In the Bronze Bow, you read a historical fiction book about what was happening in the land of Israel during the time of Jesus around 30 AD. This book tells true accounts of the Christians who lived in the 1st century and carried on the message of Jesus after he ascended into heaven. The events in this book take place from 30 AD to 350 AD. This was still a time when the Romans controlled all the areas around the Mediterranean Sea. All the people you will meet lived in Roman-occupied territories. Let's first look at a map to understand what the Roman Empire looked like at this time.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

1. Name all the bodies of water that surround the Roman Empire [A: Atlantic Ocean, Cantabrian Sea, North Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Ligurian Sea, Tyrrhenian Sea, Adriatic Sea, Ionian Sea, Aegean Sea, Adriatic Sea, Black Sea, Red Sea]
2. What country was furthest north in the Roman Empire? [A: Britain]
3. What walls were built near the northernmost part of the Roman Empire? [A: Wall of Hadrian and Wall of Antoninus]
4. What country was furthest south in the Roman Republic? [A: Egypt]
5. What country was furthest west in the Roman Republic? [A: Spain]
6. What country was furthest east in the Roman Republic? [A: Osroene]
7. What two rivers in the north formed the borders between the Roman Empire and Germany? [A: Rhine and Danube]
8. Find Jerusalem. That is where the apostles were after the ascension of Jesus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.11-12 "At no point" - "was increasingly marginalized." The last paragraph on p.13 "The story of."
2. We will read about the apostle Peter. What do you remember about him? (He cut off the ear of a soldier when Jesus was arrested in the Garden of Gethsemane, and he denied Jesus three times.) The event we will read about is told in the Bible in Acts 2. Forty days after the resurrection and ten days after Jesus ascended to heaven, about 120 followers of Christ gathered together in Jerusalem to celebrate a Jewish feast that had been celebrated since the Old Testament. p.17-21 "Peter took the" - "And prayed."

• DEFINITIONS

frayed: fragile or uncertain (p.11)

ambassador: representative or messenger (p.11)

marginalized: given an unimportant or powerless position within a society or group (p.12)

zealot: member of a first-century Jewish political movement that fiercely opposed the Roman occupation of Judea (p.20)

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26

Peter; begin Paul

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

You are reading parts of two chapters today. You will finish the chapter about Peter and find out what happened at the special event we call "The Church's Birthday." Then you will start the section on Paul, who was not one of the original twelve apostles of Jesus but was used mightily by God to spread the gospel message.

• DEFINITIONS

gale: a strong current of air (p.21)

Shavuot: Jewish holiday (p.23)

lunacy: insanity, madness (p.29)

orator: (p.29)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-25 "Peter did not know"-end

- Why is this event known as the church's birthday?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Pentecost by Giotto

Many artists have painted scenes of the Holy Spirit coming at Pentecost. Take a moment to look at this painting by Giotto, painted around 1310-1318. What is the centerpiece of the painting? (dove) What do you notice around the heads of the apostles? Artists traditionally put halos or glowing rings of light to show a holy or sacred figure. You also notice the "tongues of fire." Do you see the two men outside the doors? Giotto painted the scene using a low wall to divide those experiencing the event and those straining to hear what was going on.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.29-31 "This way!" - "but little comfort."

- Now we meet the apostle Paul, whose story is also told in the Bible. He wrote 13 of the 27 books of the New Testament. His writings were initially letters or epistles written to various churches. The story we are reading today can be found in Acts 16.

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27

Paul

📖 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Peter?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Map in the book on p.33 or Student Bible Atlas p.20-21 Find Philippi. What country is that part of? [A: Macedonia] Paul had traveled there on his missionary journeys.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-38 (whole chapter)

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Paul's Missionary Journeys

This video from the Bible Project tells more about the life of Paul and his missionary journeys.

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28

Persecution of the Church

📖 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

NOTE: We are skipping Fact Files p.39-42 and reading this PDF instead.

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Paul?

→ INTRO

You will read a chapter about why the Romans despised the Christians and how that led to persecution and the killing of Christians.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: Trial by Fire (from The Church of Our Fathers by Roland Bainton)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.22-23 that talk about Nero's treatment of Christians and the accusation that Christians were cannibals. It may not be appropriate for sensitive students.

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Skip the section about Polycarp p.23-24 "There was a" - "through Jesus Christ."

- What made Christianity so different than the religions of Rome?
- Why do you think so many Christians were willing to die for their faith?

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29

Ignatius

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.20-21

Find Antioch on the east side of the Mediterranean Sea. Why do you think that location would be a good place for trade and the spread of Christianity? Antioch was one of the largest cities in the first-century Roman world, accommodating a population between 100,000 and 300,000. There was a thriving church there made up of Jews and Gentiles, and Paul had stayed there for a whole year ministering to the people. (Acts 11) Trace a sea route to Rome that stays close to the coast.

→ INTRO

We will read about Ignatius, who was bishop of Antioch (modern-day Turkey) for forty years, probably from AD 67–106. At this time, it was the policy of the Roman government not to seek out Christians, but still to punish them when they were brought before the authorities. "Once accused and brought before the authorities, Christians had to be forced to worship the gods of the empire, or face punishment...Since great festivities were being planned in Rome in celebration of a military victory, Ignatius was sent to the capital so that his death might provide entertainment for the people. On his way to martyrdom, he wrote seven letters that are among the most valuable documents informing our knowledge of early Christianity" (Justo Gonzalez, *The Story of Christianity*).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-51

- Why do you think he had such courage to face his death?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fresco of Ignatius of Antioch

∞ Image Link: Inside view of the Colosseum (where many Christians were martyred)

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30

Polycarp

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Ignatius?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

Find Smyrna (E5). Where is it located? [A: In Asia Minor on the coast of the Aegean Sea.]

• DEFINITIONS

dotard: a person exhibiting mental decline, especially in old age (p.58)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ INTRO

We will read about another bishop and martyr of the second century. His name was Polycarp, which means 'much fruit' in Greek. Many years earlier than when this account takes place, Ignatius of Antioch had advised young Bishop Polycarp regarding his duties as bishop and the need to be firm in his faith. You may remember that Ignatius wrote 7 letters on his way to Rome. One of those letters was to Polycarp. We will read how Polycarp showed himself a worthy recipient of Ignatius's advice and a follower of his example.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.53-60

- Did you notice what the Romans called Polycarp? [A: Roman persecutors called the Christians "atheists" because they refused to worship the Roman gods.] Why is it odd to call him that?
- What do you think about Polycarp's last speech? What does it tell us about his faith?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fresco of Polycarp

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31

Cyprian

📖 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What did you remember about Polycarp?

→ LOCATE

📖 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

Find Carthage (F7). Where is it located? [A: In Africa on the Mediterranean Sea.]

→ INTRO

Cyprian was the bishop of the church in Carthage from 248 to 258 AD. His writings and teachers have been beneficial to Christians. He helped Christians navigate the question: Do we let people who denied Christ under the threat of torture and death back into the church if they repent?

→ BACKGROUND

In AD 250, the most violent persecution the church had yet faced was instigated by the emperor Decius (249–51). Decius was determined to have no nonsense from Christians. In his eyes, they were enemies of the empire. Their atheism was responsible for the many troubles in the realm. Thus, Decius commanded all citizens of the empire to sacrifice to the traditional Roman gods. Those who did so were given certificates (libelli in Latin) as evidence that they had obeyed the order. Those who refused to comply and were unable (or unwilling) to obtain false libelli from sympathetic or corrupt officials faced death. To save their lives, many Christians complied. Others were able to obtain certificates without having actually sacrificed. But an unknown number of Christians were imprisoned or executed—among them the bishops of Rome, Antioch, and Jerusalem. (Church History in Plain Language)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-78 Stop at "a different approach."

- How important is it for Christians to be part of a church body and to attend church regularly? What do you think Cyprian was saying about that topic?

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- Why do you think there was disagreement on whether those who denied their faith should be let back into the church?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Mosaic of Cyprian

∞ Image Link: Inside of Basilica of Sant'Apollinare Nuovo

This is a mosaic that is on the wall in a church in Ravenna, Italy, that was constructed in the 6th century. A mosaic is a pattern or image made of small, regular, or irregular pieces of colored stone or glass held in place by plaster and covering a surface. Mosaics are often used as floor and wall decoration, and were particularly popular in the ancient Roman world. On this wall is a procession of martyrs walking from the king's palace towards Christ's throne in heaven. In the other image, you can see the inside of the church. Polycarp was also represented in this mosaic.

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32

Cyprian/Fact Files

 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Cyprian from last time?

→ INTRO

We are going to finish up the section on Cyprian, and then we will read more about some of the practices of the early church that we still follow today. We left off with Cyprian talking about the dilemma the church had about whether they should let people back into the church if they denied Christ during the persecution. Cyprian believed the Lord called for a different approach.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.68-74 "I was wondering" - "Tertullian, and Origen."

- What do you think about Cyprians?

2. (Optional) p.75-76

3. The Apostles' Creed

∞ Image Link: The Apostles Creed

• DEFINITIONS

eucharist: communion (p.70)

WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33

Constantine

 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

When Diocletian became emperor, he thought the empire too large for one man to manage, and for that reason divided different sections out to assistant emperors. When he grew old and retired, the assistant emperors began to quarrel, and their sons as well. Constantine was the son of one, Maxentius was the son of another. Constantine held Britain and Gaul (France). Maxentius held Rome and Italy. Constantine wanted to conquer Maxentius and take control of Rome. We will read about what happened during that battle that finally brought an end to the persecution of Christians.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-86 "We are camping" - "move at daybreak."

• IMPORTANT DATES

313 Edict of Milan that ended persecution

• DEFINITIONS

reconnaissance: military activity in which soldiers are sent to find out information about an enemy (p.79)

prone: lying flat (p.81)

augur: one held to foretell events by omens (p.84)

pacifist: a person who opposes war or warlike policies (p.85)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Chi-Ro Symbol (used in the ancient Roman Empire)
Emperor Constantine used the Chi-Rho symbol on his shields and coinage after his conversion, and it was used as a Christian symbol for many centuries on tombstones, mosaics, cups, tiles, and manuscripts. It is made from two Greek letters (X and ρ). They are the first two letters of the word Christ, and this symbol came to represent Christ, or Christianity.

WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34

Finish Constantine/Athanasius

📖 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

Note: This lesson is broken into two sections.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about Constantine?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-88 "The battle progressed" - "the next chapter."

→ INTRO

Athanasius is an important person from church history who lived from 293-373 in Alexandria, Egypt, which was part of the Roman Empire. He is known as the Father of Orthodoxy. Do you know what orthodoxy means? It comes from two Greek words. Orthos means right, true, and straight. Doxa means opinion. It refers to true religious beliefs. Athanasius helped Christians understand that Jesus is fully God and fully man. At that time, there was a man named Arius who argued that the Father alone was truly God and that the Son was the first and greatest creature made by the Father. That is not biblical. Athanasius defended the truth even when it was hard. What would it mean if Jesus were not truly God?

→ MAP WORK

📖 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.18-19

1. Find Alexandria on the map. What country is it located in? [A: Egypt]
2. What bodies of water are near this city? [A: Mediterranean Sea and Nile River (Delta)]
3. Why would this be a good location for a bustling city? [Being near these bodies of water made it an ideal location for international trade.]
4. Based on the name of this city, who might the founder be? [A: It was founded by Alexander the Great in 331 B.C.] It was later taken over by the Roman Emperor Octavius. Athanasius lived in this important city.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91- top of 95 "The battle progressed" - "the speakers forth."

• DEFINITIONS

queries: a question or a request for information about something (p.93)

WEEK 11 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35

Finish Athanasius

📖 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

📖 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.16-17

1. Today, we will read about a council of bishops that came to Nicaea. Find Nicaea on the map. (E6) What ancient country was it located in? [A: Bithynia]

• IMPORTANT DATES

325 Council of Nicaea

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3	
2. What modern country is it located in? [A: Turkey] 3. What bodies of water are near this city? Why would this be a good location for a council for people to travel to from various parts of the Roman Empire? [A: While not on the shores of either, it is between the Black Sea and the Mediterranean Sea.] → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.95-99 "It took Eusebius" - "of Jesus Christ." (Optional) p.100-103 → VIEW ∞ Image Link: Image of Athanasius	
WEEK 12  25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times	

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

Examination

- Term 1** · Tell what happened between the Roman soldiers and the Jewish people that added to Rosh and Daniel's anger.
- Term 2** · Tell about how the character of Daniel's sister, Leah, and how her story changes as they learn more about Jesus. OR Tell about how Daniel learns more about Jesus and how that changes his anger.
- Term 3** · Tell all you know about one of the people you read about in "Redemption" and how they were important in church history.